

lection. You can scan and store your important documents such as driving licence, PAN card and ID card in digital form on your system. For rather creative tasks like kids' artworks, photographs can be scanned to make a large compilation of multiple photo albums.

Scanning is fast replacing the need for a fax machine. Scanning documents and sharing them through e-mail/cloud services is becoming a common trend.

Majority of the MFPs are flatbeds, which are suitable for scanning photos or single-sheet documents. For quantity-intensive tasks, an automatic document feeder will allow you to scan and copy multi-page documents easily.

Copying

For photocopying of college notes and project reports, most of us still rely on those street-side photocopy shops. For bulk jobs, those large, off-white washing machine like copiers offer unmatched efficiency in terms of price. But what if in the wee hours of night, when all the shops have shut down, you realise that you have to submit two copies

Some Popular MFPs						
Brand/ Specifications	Model name	Printing type	ppm (pages per minute)	Input tray capacity	Media size supported	Price (in rupees)
Canon	Pixma MP287	Inkjet	4.8 ipm*	100 pages	A4, A5, B5	3360
Epson	Epson Stylus TX121	Inkjet	15	100 pages	A4, A5, A6, B5	3499
HP	1050 All-in-One J410a	Inkjet	12	60 pages	A4, A5, A6, B5, DL	3799
Canon	Pixma MX416	Inkjet with Fax	5 ipm*	30 pages	A4, A5, B5, DL	6499
Epson	Office ME 620F	Inkjet with Fax	15	120 pages	A4, A5, A6, B5, DL, C6	6356
HP	HP Officejet 4500 All-in-One G510h	Inkjet with Fax	22	100 pages	A4, A5, B5, C6, DL	7299

**Just like ppm, images per minute (ipm) is a way of measuring the speed of a printer, ipm denotes the number of single-sized 21.6x27.9cm* (8.5x11-inch*) sheets that a printer can print in one minute. ppm rate is used more for documents, whereas ipm is used for images and graphics*

of your assignment the next morning. In such a scenario, that feature-rich MFP would come to your rescue.

MFPs with the copying function allow users to duplicate documents and images in colour as well as monochrome. Many of them allow copying without a PC, which means without switching on your system you can use the printer as a standalone copier.

Look out for MFPs with LCDs. The LCD adds to the convenience of operating with options like preview and selection of the documents and images to be printed.

Speed

An entry-level MFP can print 12-16 colour pages per minute (ppm). As you move up the ladder, particularly in the laser series, it can give you up to 22 ppm without a cry!

Cost

A below-Rs 5000 MFP might sound music to your ears but do not forget to add the cost of ink cartridges that it will need periodically. It is advisable to do a thorough check of the relative cost of the ink cartridges. Also, be sure to check the duty cycle of the printer, i.e., the number of pages it can print/copy in one go of the cartridge capacity. ●



HP Officejet 4500 All-in-One G510h multifunction printer

Connectivity

Printing documents and images through a PC isn't the only function offered by an MFP. To serve multiple connection points, MFPs come with Ethernet and WiFi support for network-based printing. Additionally, many of them come with a media card slot that eliminates the need to turn on your PC for printing.

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